

Survival Story

Cancer is the second biggest killer in India but studies show survival rates are going up in certain kinds

Mouth

About 3,00,000 tobacco-related new cancer cases are reported every year, while 2,000 die of it daily in the country. Four in 10 of all cancers in India are oral.

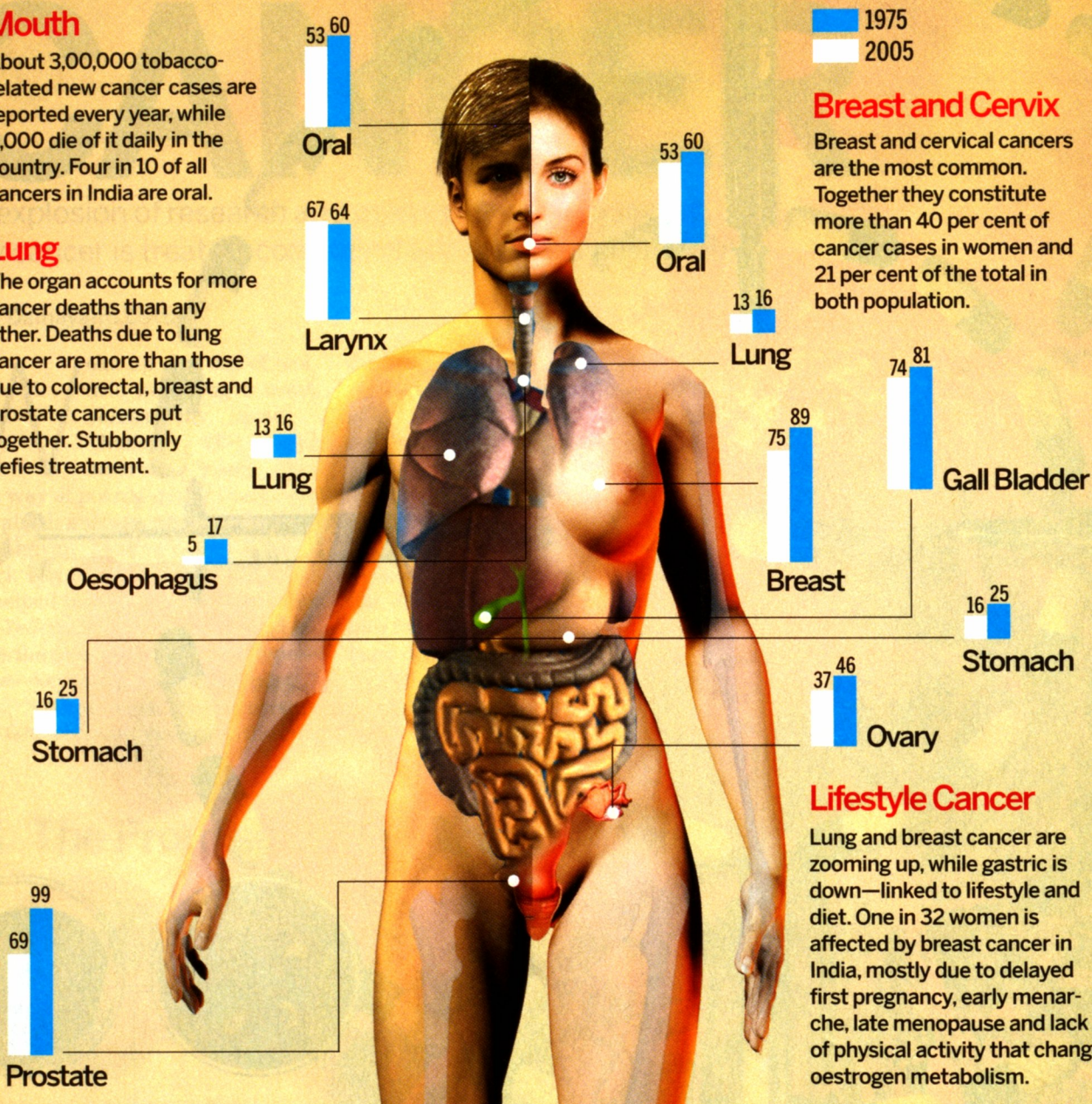
Lung

The organ accounts for more cancer deaths than any other. Deaths due to lung cancer are more than those due to colorectal, breast and prostate cancers put together. Stubbornly defies treatment.

1975
2005

Breast and Cervix

Breast and cervical cancers are the most common. Together they constitute more than 40 per cent of cancer cases in women and 21 per cent of the total in both population.



Lifestyle Cancer

Lung and breast cancer are zooming up, while gastric is down—linked to lifestyle and diet. One in 32 women is affected by breast cancer in India, mostly due to delayed first pregnancy, early menarche, late menopause and lack of physical activity that change oestrogen metabolism.

THE NUMBERS GAME

● Cancer is the **2nd** biggest cause of death in India, growing at **11%** annually.

● There are **2.5 mn** cancer cases and **4,00,000** deaths a year in India.

● In 1991, **0.6 mn** new cancer cases were diagnosed. Rose to **0.8 mn** in 2009.

● Smoking **1-7** cigarettes every day nearly doubles the cancer risk.

● **36** per 1,00,000 men as against **45** women suffer from cancer.

Source: Cancer Atlas by ICMR in 2005; NEJM 2008